Tableau Products

What is the Tableau Platform?

Tableau is one of the world's leading data analysis and visualization platforms. It incorporates data management, governance, visualization, and collaboration and is underpinned by the Einstein Discovery AI machine learning no-code environment developed by Salesforce.

There are several different flavors of the Tableau platform to choose from based on your needs and budget.

Tableau Public

Tableau Public is a no-cost platform that enables you to explore, create, and share your data visualizations with others online. It is accessible to anyone, allowing you to create visualizations either using the online Web Authoring tool in Tableau Public or the free Tableau Desktop (Public Edition). As the name suggests, the Tableau Desktop (Public Edition) is an app-based version of the Tableau Public online platform which you can run from your desktop. In the next video in this course, you will see a demonstration of how to download and install this edition of Tableau. The feature set of the Tableau Public platform and the Tableau Desktop (Public Edition) are virtually identical.

Tableau Public offers you an extensive collection of appealing data visualizations to explore and learn from. This helps to hone your data visualization skills to build an online portfolio of your work.

Tableau Public is a great place to get started with data visualization, regardless of your skill level. It's free, easy to use, and has a large community of users to learn from.

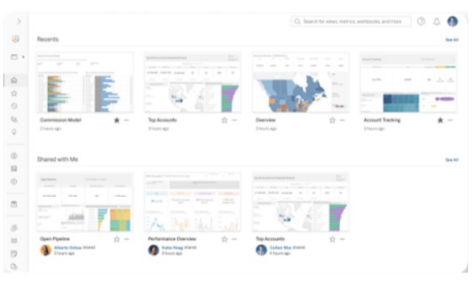
Visualizations shared on Tableau Public are accessible for anyone to view on the internet. Tableau Public is a platform exclusively designed for public data, not private data.

Anyone has the ability to explore and add to the extensive collection of visualizations on Tableau Public. However, there are restrictions on saving data locally and refreshing it.

Visualizations are fully hosted on Tableau Public, and therefore, it can accommodate millions of viewers while the underlying infrastructure is maintained by Tableau Public free of charge.

Tableau Cloud

Tableau Cloud is the successor to Tableau Online, enabling you to make more intelligent, insight-guided decisions through quick, versatile, and user-friendly analytics. It provides a comprehensive, enterprise-level data analytics solution in the cloud. You can use the intuitive self-service platform to connect to your data easily and quickly, visualize and analyze your data, and then collaborate with others by sharing your work in the cloud.



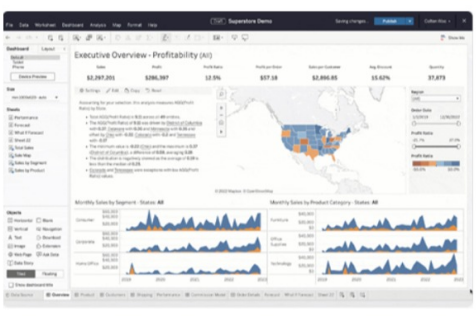
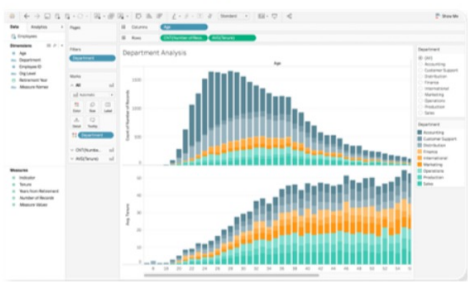


Tableau Desktop (as part of Tableau Creator)

Tableau Desktop provides you with all the tools you need to connect to your data in order to visualize and analyze it using its user-friendly drag-and-drop interface. This will enable you to uncover previously hidden insights in your data, thus allowing you to make more informed and intelligent business decisions more quickly, all within a secure self-service environment. Users with Tableau Desktop can also freely publish their work on Tableau Public.

Tableau Desktop is now only available as part of the **Tableau Creator** package which also includes **Tableau Prep Builder** and one *Creator* license on **Tableau Cloud**.



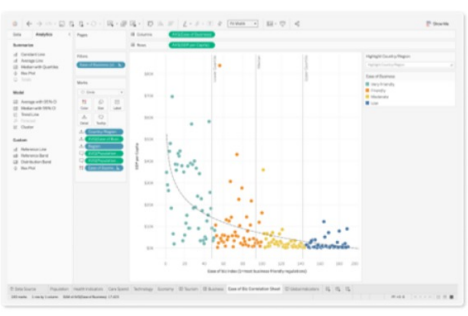


Tableau Prep Builder (as part of Tableau Creator)

Tableau Prep Builder offers a contemporary method for data preparation, which simplifies the process of combining, arranging, and cleansing your data, giving you faster and more efficient data analysis within your Tableau product.

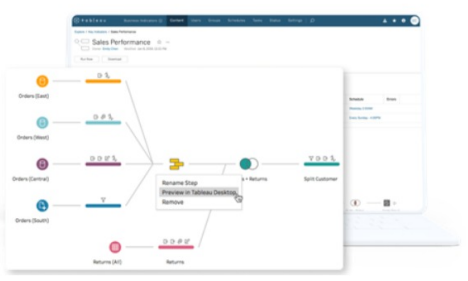
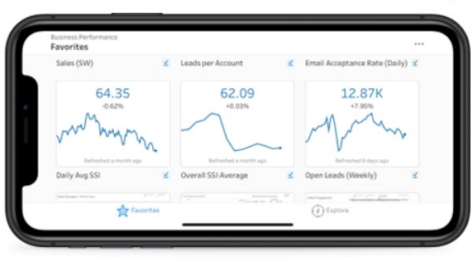


Tableau Mobile

With Tableau, you can create dashboards that your team members and colleagues can access from mobile devices, such as smartphones and tablets. Tableau automatically generates dashboard layouts, which are designed for optimal performance on these mobile devices. Tableau Mobile allows you to have easy and instant access to your data hosted in Tableau Server or Tableau Desktop, regardless of where you are, giving you the most up-to-date information in order to make better business decisions while on the go.



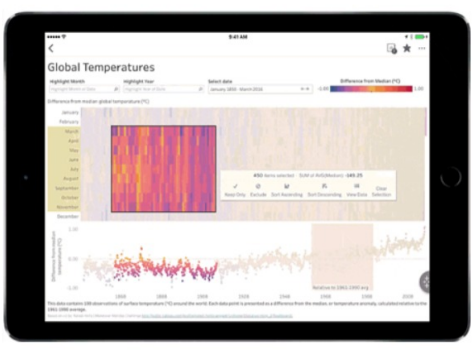
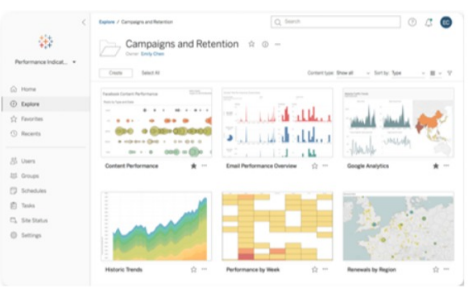


Tableau Server

Tableau Server is a business intelligence platform that is designed to enable organizations to share, collaborate on, and distribute interactive and visually appealing dashboards and reports created with Tableau Desktop. Tableau Server allows users to publish Tableau workbooks and data sources to a central server, making them accessible to a broader audience within the organization. This ability to extend the accessibility of your data across your organization allows your users to explore data within a trusted, secure, reliable, and controlled environment.



Key Features of Tableau

Tableau is a powerful data visualization tool that helps businesses explore and analyze their data to gain insights and make informed decisions. Some of the key features of Tableau are:

- **Drag-and-Drop Interface:** Tableau's intuitive drag-and-drop interface makes it easy to create data visualizations without any coding knowledge. You can simply drag and drop dimensions and measures onto shelves to create charts, graphs, and maps.
- **Wide Range of Data Sources:** Tableau connects to a wide variety of data sources, including spreadsheets, databases, cloud applications, and big data platforms. This flexibility allows you to analyze data from multiple sources in a single platform.
- **Real-Time Data Connection:** Tableau can connect to live data sources, enabling you to analyze and visualize data as it changes. This real-time capability is particularly useful for monitoring business performance and making timely decisions.
- **Advanced Visualization Capabilities:** Tableau offers a wide range of visualization types, including bar charts, line charts, scatter plots, maps, and heatmaps. You can customize the appearance and formatting of your visualizations to create visually appealing and informative data representations.
- **Data Blending and Calculations:** Tableau allows you to blend data from multiple sources and create calculated fields to derive new insights from your data. This flexibility makes it possible to analyze complex data sets and uncover hidden patterns and trends. You can create custom calculations and calculated fields to derive new insights from the data, providing a high level of flexibility in analysis.
- **Interactive Dashboards and Stories:** Tableau enables you to create interactive dashboards and stories to provide a comprehensive overview of your data and allow users to explore and filter data in an intuitive way.
- **Collaboration and Sharing:** Tableau supports collaboration features that allow you to share your data visualizations and dashboards with others. You can publish your work to Tableau Server or Tableau Online, enabling others to view and interact with your data. You can also use the Web Authoring tool in the free Tableau Public platform to connect to data and create visualizations online.
- **Mobile and Web Access:** Tableau dashboards are responsive and can be accessed on mobile devices and web browsers, making it easy to share insights with colleagues and stakeholders who may not have access to Tableau Desktop.
- **Scalability and Performance:** Tableau can handle large datasets and provide fast performance, making it suitable for businesses of all sizes. Tableau also offers various performance optimization techniques to ensure that your data visualizations remain responsive even with large amounts of data.
- **Scheduled Refresh and Automation:** Tableau supports scheduled data refreshing, ensuring that visualizations stay up to date with the latest data. Automation features help streamline repetitive tasks.
- **Advanced Analytics Integration:** Tableau integrates with R and Python for advanced analytics, allowing users to leverage statistical and predictive modeling within their visualizations.
- **Extensive Community and Resources:** Tableau has a large and active user community, providing forums, documentation, and resources for learning and troubleshooting.
- **Data Governance and Security:** Tableau offers a variety of data governance and security features to help you protect your data. Tableau provides features for data security, including row-level security, data source authentication and data encryption, and granular permissions control. This ensures that sensitive data is accessed only by authorized users.

Author(s)

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